

MALDIVESNASRULLAADAMEDITupdate

Travel Radio Australia and we are visiting the fantastic Maldives. What a beautiful destination and I have with me Nasrullah Adam. He's the Chief Commercial Officer of the Visit Maldives Corporation which is the National Tourism Board.

Nasrullah, welcome to the program. Thank you. Now Nasrullah, the Maldives is a bucket list destination for so many millions of people from around the world.

Can you give us a general overview of the country itself and what it has to offer? Well, like you said, the Maldives is a favorite destination for global markets all over the world. We have just achieved two million visitors arrival to the Maldives in 2025 which is a very good achievement. Yeah, seasonally wise, Maldives welcomes tourists all around the world throughout the year.

It's always sunny. We share the sunny side of life and that remains for years and years and people just love it. There is infrastructure improvements every year.

So we just opened the new terminal which allows more connectivity options from global markets. New flights come into the destinations, new brands come into the destination and it's improving day by day. Now you have these groups of islands which have the hotels and hotels of all sizes, big ones, small ones, boutique islands that you can actually be right on the water, right on the reef.

You can just jump out of your bed basically and just jump in the water. It's a fantastic experience. Yes, that's right.

The concept in our luxury resort is one island, one resort concept which makes it special compared to other destinations. What's important then one island, one resort concept is also, let's say for example, other destinations also have beautiful beaches, amazing properties, hotels, resorts, but then what's unique about Maldives is the people, the hospitality, warmth of the people. This is well recognized by the travelers and they keep coming back again and again.

Recently we welcomed a couple from UK. They have been in the Maldives 70 times which is a very good story to tell. To one resort they have been more than 60 times.

So I would say people come back to get the warm hospitality from the Maldivian people. I would say this is one reason why Maldives is unique and loved by many people around the world. I was looking on and you can see this on YouTube and the video of the most fantastic groups of hotels and you call them atolls.

Is it atolls? We have 1190 islands naturally and then these are divided into group of islands called atolls. Yeah, if you look that up, I mean it's so spectacular. They have the helicopter shots of these atolls, atolls with groups of islands on them.

It's so beautiful. Now tell us about the sea life there. You've got diving, you've got snorkeling.

It is one of the number one destinations in the world for that sort of activity. For us the marine life is very important. When we say marine life, we have from dolphins to manta rays, stingrays, whale sharks, tiger sharks.

These are some of the reasons why people choose Maldives. Yeah, there are specific locations if somebody is interested to visit. When we talk about marine life, we have opportunities for people to see dolphins, different type of fish, coral, whether it is like table corals or soft corals.

We also have the manta rays and also tiger sharks. Tiger shark is very popular in some of the areas in the Maldives. Yeah, whale sharks.

So basically when people choose the Maldives, they choose based on their likings. So someone who is interested to see the mantas, they go to the bay atoll, which is a common choice for those who love the adventure and see the manta rays. It's not only the resorts.

We also have the local tourism, the guest houses. There are beautiful guest houses in the local islands where you will be able to see the local life, mingle with the local people, see their culture, the cuisine. Maldives also have very rich in terms of the cuisine.

Could you give us a couple of your hidden gems, a couple of places that may be a little bit off the beaten track that you know about and the locals know about that the people should try and get to as a really special experience? We always notice that when customers decide, one of the factors is that they want to be close to the airport. But then what they don't know is there are hidden gems around different atolls. Let's say, for example, the islands, the beaches over north side of the Maldives will be different from the middle of the Maldives.

And again, when we talk about the southern part of the Maldives, the culture, the marine life is again different. Instead of sticking to one specific area, it's always good to explore different parts of the Maldives. There are hidden small islands, the culture from atoll to atoll is different, the kind of food that you get to experience, people, the behavior, what they do daily basis.

The excursions are different from atoll to atoll as And transport from the capital, can you tell us about the capital and the transport options as well? The main means of transportation to the resorts are seaplane, a speedboat. Some they take luxury yachts from Mali to some of the islands. Yeah, we also have domestic flights that connects from Mali to other islands.

There are a lot of domestic airports. For a first time visitor to the Maldives, they obviously want to see Maldives from the above and seaplane ride is already a very good experience, right? When they are close to Mali, the option people choose more is a speedboat ride. I'm chatting with Nasrullah Adam.

He's the chief commercial officer for Visit Maldives Corporation, the National Tourism Board of the Maldives. Nasrullah, how can people find out more about Maldives online? At the moment, we are enhancing our website, which obviously will give not just a brief of what we offer. So you will get to know different atolls, which resorts are located, what are the kind of kind of resorts basically, things that you can do, experiences, unique factors of the Maldives, who to contact if you looking to arrange a vacation to the Maldives.

All the partner resorts, the DMCs, travel legends are also listed in our website. General information about Maldives, you can get it from visitmaldives.com. Well, thank you so much for your time, Nasrullah. Maldives has been on my bucket list for many, many years.

And one day I'm going to get there and do more interviews for Travel Radio World. And it's going to be a fantastic thing. So if you're thinking of going, check out the website, visitmaldives.com. I'm sure that most of us will try and get there sometime in our lives and have the most wonderful time.

Thanks for being with us, Nasrullah Adam. Thank you. And it's been a pleasure.